

tertiary Ariá does play an important role in other matters; when delving into the dreams of others, the tertiary Ariá “wakes up” and becomes more active.

The Seelie and Unseelie Legacies can be found on pp. 156–160, and the Nightmare Legacies on pp. 370–371. The Storyteller should choose one to represent each of the Denizen’s Ariás.

Below is a description of each of the three Ariá.

The Dioniae

The most basic instincts are the Dioniae’s prime concern. Dark-kin ruled by this Ariá are often aggressive and focused only on short-term goals; hunting for food, a mate, or a source of Glamour are their priorities. They have little regard for the consequences of the short-sighted actions they will take to accomplish these goals and attain their prizes. Rarely do they show concern for others around them, and if they do it is only after they have made sure they have glutted themselves on whatever it is they were seeking.

While these survival instincts are not a bad thing in and of themselves, if left unchecked they can quickly become destructive. Denizens ruled by the Dioniae show little regard for such common conventions as etiquette, and have no issue voicing concerns or thoughts that would shock and appall even questionably polite company. In the same vein, they have no trouble acting upon their basest desires, even when most would deem the time, place, or both inappropriate.

Beginning Glamour: 4

Beginning Willpower: 2

The Araminae

Walking the line between indulgences is the Araminae. The most pragmatic and sensible of the Ariá, Denizens ruled by this mindset are the most rational of the Dark-kin. It offers a more balanced perspective to the base desires of the Dioniae and the cerebral ideals of the Apolliae. Though still influenced by either of these urges, Araminae Denizens have the most level heads when going about achieving their goals.

Applying order to the chaos of the Dark-kin’s mind brings them the closest to a human condition, and those that walk this path do not seem entirely different from humanity on the surface. However, very close are the desires of the ultimately inhuman Denizen in question. The Araminae does not so much remove them from their urges as mask them particularly well behind careful thought and uncharacteristic patience. Acting more as a guiding force than anything else, the Araminae is ultimately as self-interested as the Dioniae or Apolliae; it is simply more willing to take a roundabout route.

Beginning Glamour: 3

Beginning Willpower: 3

The Apolliae

While the Dioniae is concerned with satisfying basic desires, the Apolliae is focused on fulfilling a higher purpose. Attempting to create order in chaos, those ruled by this Ariá

develop a strict moral code, and follow it to the letter — even if it goes against her best interest. These Denizens believe they have a calling they must answer, and favor indulging the soul over the body. This instinct to find a purpose is a driving force in their lives, and guides every decision the Denizen makes. While the pursuit of a “higher self” is usually a noble one, what exactly meets that goal is highly dependent on the one setting it.

While functioning in a limited capacity as a sense of conscience, the Apolliae represents more a strict set of rules the Dark-kin will follow. Nothing prevents recreational violence or ritualistic arson from being among those rules; ethics are highly personal things, and any number of lenses can make even the most despicable things palatable. For these Dark-kin, it’s simply a matter of perspective and justification, and both are provided by their unwavering, albeit warped, moral compasses.

Beginning Glamour: 2

Beginning Willpower: 4

Adhene

Following are the seven adhene — the Dark-kin equivalent of kiths. Included with each description is a brief discussion of how the Denizen views and uses the three Ariás, and their respective Birthrights and Frailties.

Acheri

From the ashes grows life anew...but someone had to make the ashes in the first place. The acheri see themselves as perpetrators of the cycle of life, an outside force to weed out the weak and let the strong prevail. To this end, they have mastered all forms of disease and temptation, and exercise these skills liberally amongst themselves and others. If ever questioned on the ethics or morals of their actions, acheri usually counter with an argument that death is merely part of the cycle of life, and the cycle is a necessary thing for the world to continue turning.

Ariá

Acheri look almost entirely human, a member of whatever culture imagined them. Their voile tends toward extremes — rich and decadent or ragged and poor — and in every Ariá they have an abnormally dark, cold shadow. This even holds true, to a lesser extent, in the waking worlds.

Dioniae: These acheri have an aura of corruption, carrying illness and temptation with them wherever they go. The symptoms, physical and spiritual, are subtle, and most sufferers don’t pinpoint the acheri as the source of the urges they feel when around one. Their base desires simply seem closer to the surface. Disease proliferates anywhere an acheri lingers.

Araminae: The unease exuded by acheri is amplified in this Ariá, and is evidenced in their sickly appearance. Their skin takes on a sunken, sallow appearance and sickly undertones; they may have rashes and sores that ooze, or blisters and boils that frequently pop. They are plainly unhealthy, and the manifestation drops their Appearance by one point.